Escalation Authority Module (EAM)

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Canonical Definition

Escalation Authority Module (EAM) defines the structural conditions under which escalation authority is assigned, recognized, transferred, and governed when autonomous operation requires higher-level operational control.

EAM governs escalation authority.

The module establishes the governance conditions required to ensure that every escalation is directed to the appropriate governance authority capable of making legitimate operational decisions.

A trigger initiates escalation.

Authority determines who receives it.

EAM governs that authority.

Module Operational Role

EAM defines the escalation authority layer of AESS.

Its role is to ensure that autonomous operational escalation is transferred to the correct governance authority without ambiguity or delay.

Module Operational Space

EAM governs:

- escalation authority,
- escalation ownership,
- authority transfer,
- governance authority assignment,
- escalation decision authority,
- operational control transfer,
- governed escalation authority,
- escalation responsibility.

Module Function

The module applies wherever organizations must define which governance authority is responsible for receiving, evaluating, and acting upon autonomous operational escalations.

Minimum Implementation Framework

1. Define the Escalation Authority Object

Identify which governance authorities are responsible for different escalation scenarios.

2. Define Authority Conditions

Establish governance conditions governing authority assignment and escalation ownership.

3. Define Authority Failure Logic

Identify conditions where escalation authority is unclear, unavailable, conflicting, or governance-invalid.

4. Define Governance Response

Define governance actions for authority reassignment, operational intervention, escalation routing, delegation, or emergency control transfer.

5. Preserve Authority Traceability

Preserve authority assignments, governance decisions, operational evidence, escalation records, and supporting documentation.

Use Case 1 — Autonomous Hospital Robot

Scenario

An autonomous surgical support robot encounters an unexpected clinical condition requiring human intervention.

Application

EAM routes the escalation to the responsible supervising surgeon and clinical governance authority.

Result

Operational responsibility is transferred without delay to the appropriate decision-maker.

Use Case 2 — Autonomous Power Grid Control System

Scenario

An autonomous energy management platform detects a critical infrastructure anomaly requiring immediate operational oversight.

Application

EAM assigns escalation to the authorized grid operations controller according to predefined governance rules.

Result

The escalation reaches the correct operational authority, preserving governance integrity and operational continuity.

Canonical Closing Statement

Governable escalation requires governable authority. Escalation Authority ensures that every autonomous operational escalation reaches the legitimate governance authority responsible for safe, accountable, and timely operational decisions.

Related Documents

→ Autonomous Escalation Standard (AESS)

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Canonical Source

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